HITTER EVALUATION · R&D ADVANCE REPORT

# Juan Soto

NYM · Bats L · Age 27 · 1,929 pitches seen · 111 G

**Hitter evaluation**
2026 regular season
Data through **2026-09-27**
MLBAM 665742

| PA | AVG/OBP/SLG | WOBA | XWOBA | WRC+ | HR | K% | BB% | BARREL% | HARD-HIT% | AVG / MAX EV | SPD (FG) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 482 | .275/.393/.515 | .385 | .411 | 147 | 27 | 13.5% | 16.2% | 13.9% | 48.1% | 92.2 / 114.2 | 4.0 |

## BOTTOM LINE

1. **Plus-plus swing decisions (70):** 19.7% chase (97th pct), 63% zone swing, 16.2% BB.
2. **Punishes sweepers:** RV/100 +4.9 (league +0.0), .510 xwOBA on contact (n=149) — avoid in the zone.
3. **Plus hit tool (65):** 81% contact, xBA .295, 13.5% K.
4. **Plus power (65):** 13.9% barrels/BBE (92nd pct), EV90 106.8 mph, max 114.2, ISO .240.
5. **Platoon split — weaker vs LHP:** .344 wOBA vs LHP, .405 vs RHP (60 pts; xwOBA .360 / .441; 165 / 300 PA) — a matchup lever late in games.

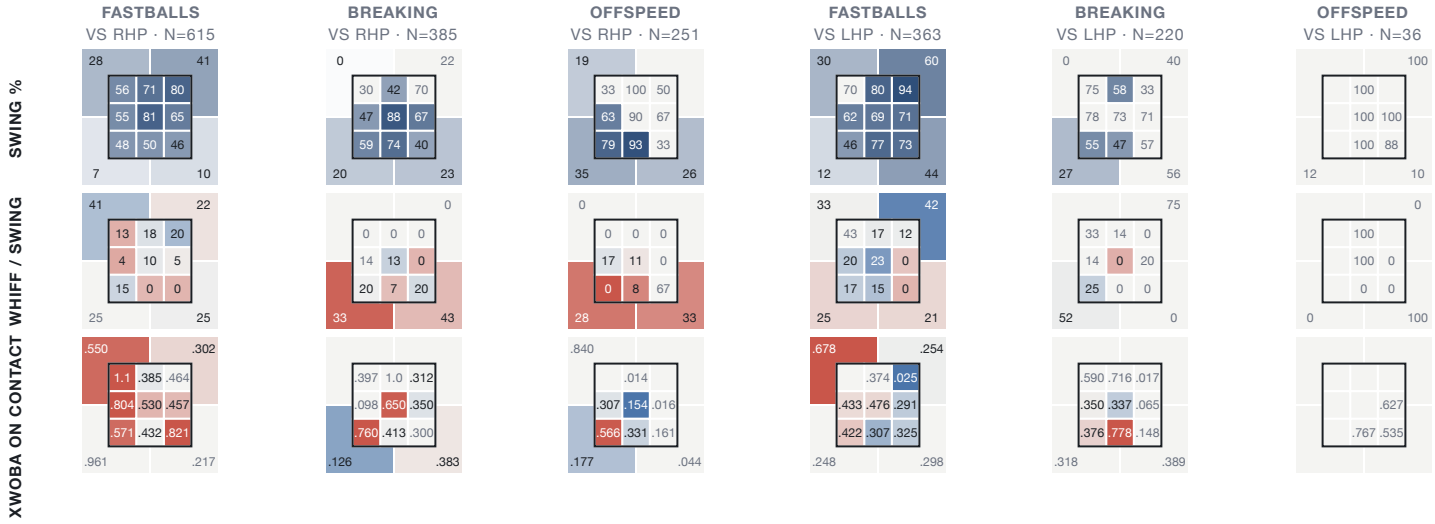
## 20–80 GRADES

vs 310 hitters ≥1,000 pitches

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Hit** | 65 | Contact 81% |
| **Power** | 65 | Barrel 13.9% |
| **Discipline** | 70 | Chase 20% |
| **Pull-air** | 50 | 18% of BBE |
| **Speed (Spd)** | 50 | Spd 4.0 |
| **vs pitch group** | 65 FB +1.6 | 75 BRK +2.6 | 55 OFF +1.0 |

## ZONES Swing decisions & damage — damage on offspeed down & away vs RHP (.566 xwOBAcon); misses fastballs chase up & in vs LHP (42% whiff vs 24% league)

Catcher's view, 13 zones (3×3 strike zone + 4 chase quadrants); hitter-relative, so 'in' flips by side. Swing%: darker = swings more (frequency, not quality). Whiff and xwOBA on contact are tinted vs the league rate in the same zone and pitch group (red = better for the hitter). Grey = small sample (<12 pitches, <8 swings, <5 balls in play).



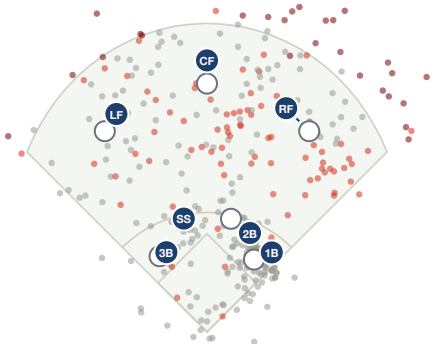

## PITCH TYPES Pitch types — best vs sweeper (+4.9 RV/100), worst vs splitter (-1.7)

All pitches seen, both hands. RV/100 = hitter run value per 100 pitches (+ = good for him); Lg = league average for the band. Tints vs league band rates; grey rows n < 80. FF bands overlap (velo and ride).

| PITCH / BAND | N | SWING | WHIFF | CHASE | XWOBACON | XWOBA | RV/100 | LG |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **FF 96+ mph** | 181 | 46% | 26% | 29% | .686 | .469 | +2.5 | -0.4 |
| **FF 93–95.9** | 163 | 49% | 21% | 24% | .450 | .429 | +0.4 | +0.0 |
| **FF < 93** | 93 | 43% | 5% | 17% | .448 | .451 | +4.3 | +0.6 |
| **FF ride ≥ 18 in** | 104 | 46% | 15% | 28% | .464 | .372 | +2.5 | -0.8 |
| **Sinker** | 415 | 43% | 15% | 22% | .429 | .425 | +0.7 | -0.3 |
| **Cutter** | 126 | 36% | 18% | 16% | .380 | .413 | +3.1 | +0.0 |
| **Slider** | 271 | 33% | 20% | 17% | .398 | .398 | +0.9 | -0.0 |
| **Sweeper** | 149 | 39% | 22% | 19% | .510 | .449 | +4.9 | +0.0 |
| **Curveball** | 185 | 32% | 25% | 18% | .404 | .371 | +3.3 | +0.3 |
| **Changeup** | 199 | 44% | 14% | 27% | .400 | .385 | +2.1 | +0.0 |
| **Splitter** | 88 | 42% | 24% | 16% | .248 | .299 | -1.7 | -0.1 |

## SPRAY Spray — 49% pulled; shift-legal alignment adds +2.1 outs/100 BIP (cross-validated)

All balls in play (grey out, red hit, dark red HR). Hollow = standard alignment, navy = optimized (2 IF each side of 2B, IF on dirt).




| BIP MIX | PULL | CENT | OPPO | PULL-AIR | GB | LD | FB | PU |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Soto** n=337 | **49%** | **31%** | **20%** | **18%** | **39%** | **19%** | **33%** | **9%** |
| League | 45% | 28% | 27% | 17% | 42% | 24% | 27% | 7% |

**Alignment:** +2.1 outs per 100 BIP vs standard, cross-validated (+9.5 in-sample; n=337 BIP batting L). RF 8° toward opposite side, 16 ft deeper; 2B 12° toward pull side, 10 ft shallower; CF 0° toward pull side, 30 ft deeper.

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NYM · Bats L · 2026 · through **2026-09-27**

## ATTACK How to attack — finish with sweeper down & away vs RHP

Model-preferred pitch (lowest expected xwOBA vs this hitter from a league-average arsenal) and its best location, by count bucket and pitcher hand; second-best and the pitch to avoid with expected xwOBA. Grey line = his actual results on that pitch group in that zone.

| COUNT | VS RHP | | | VS LHP | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Even**<br>0-0, 1-1, 2-2 | Sweeper → Down & away<br>his breaking there: 20% whiff · .760 xwOBAcon · n=17 | .282<br>2nd SL .293 | avoid **SI** .322 | Sweeper → Down & away<br>his breaking there: 25% whiff · .376 xwOBAcon · n=22 | .276<br>2nd SL .282 | avoid **SI** .301 |
| **Ahead**<br>0-1, 0-2, 1-2 | Sweeper → Chase down & in<br>his breaking there: 43% whiff · .383 xwOBAcon · n=133 | .306<br>2nd FF .315 | avoid **SI** .336 | Four-seam → Down & away<br>his fastballs there: 17% whiff · .422 xwOBAcon · n=26 | .300<br>2nd ST .301 | avoid **SI** .317 |
| **Behind**<br>1-0, 2-0, 2-1, 3-1 | Sweeper → Down & away<br>his breaking there: 20% whiff · .760 xwOBAcon · n=17 | .282<br>2nd SL .297 | avoid **SI** .325 | Sweeper → Down & away<br>his breaking there: 25% whiff · .376 xwOBAcon · n=22 | .288<br>2nd FF .292 | avoid **FS** .313 |
| **Two-strike**<br>0-2, 1-2, 2-2, 3-2 | Sweeper → Down & away<br>his breaking there: 20% whiff · .760 xwOBAcon · n=17 | .303<br>2nd CU .319 | avoid **SI** .344 | Sweeper → Down & away<br>his breaking there: 25% whiff · .376 xwOBAcon · n=22 | .302<br>2nd FF .313 | avoid **SI** .326 |

## COUNTS Count tendencies — swings at 24% of first pitches (league 32%); chases 34% with two strikes (league 41%)

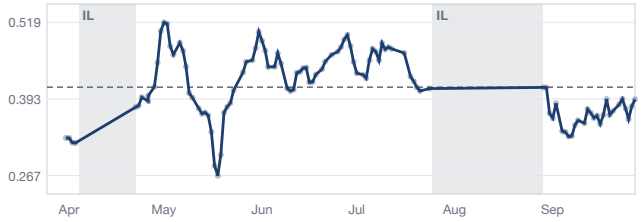
Small numbers = percentage-point difference from league in that count. Chase/whiff tinted vs league (red = better for the hitter); xwOBA on contact tinted vs league. Grey = n < 25 pitches.

| BY COUNT | 0-0 | 1-0 | 2-0 | 3-0 | 0-1 | 1-1 | 2-1 | 3-1 | 0-2 | 1-2 | 2-2 | 3-2 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Pitches | 483 | 213 | 104 | 40 | 223 | 187 | 124 | 53 | 94 | 161 | 150 | 97 |
| Swing % | 24<br>-8 | 25<br>-17 | 34<br>-5 | 8<br>+1 | 37<br>-12 | 51<br>-4 | 60<br>+3 | 32<br>-19 | 40<br>-11 | 57<br>-1 | 57<br>-7 | 69<br>-1 |
| Chase % | 9<br>-9 | 9<br>-15 | 20<br>-0 | 4<br>+1 | 17<br>-13 | 18<br>-16 | 30<br>-3 | 7<br>-19 | 26<br>-10 | 32<br>-9 | 37<br>-8 | 44<br>-2 |
| Whiff / swing | 20<br>-4 | 11<br>-12 | 20<br>+0 | 33<br>+20 | 22<br>-4 | 21<br>-3 | 19<br>-2 | 24<br>+6 | 24<br>-2 | 23<br>-1 | 13<br>-8 | 13<br>-3 |
| xwOBA on contact | .350 | .425 | .377 | .837 | .530 | .489 | .538 | .499 | .552 | .331 | .396 | .391 |

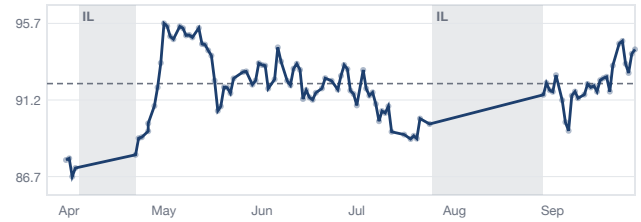
## TRENDS Trends — steady relative to his season line

15-game rolling (min 5 games); dashed = season. ⚑ = latest window differs by ≥.045 xwOBA, 2 mph EV or 5 pts chase. Grey = IL: Apr 4–Apr 22 (Right calf strain); Jul 25–Aug 29 (Left calf strain).

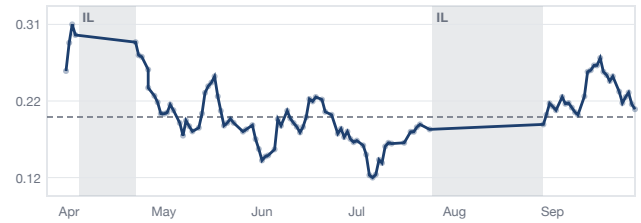
**xwOBA — 15-game rolling**




**Avg exit velo — 15-game rolling**




**Chase rate — 15-game rolling**




## SPLITS Platoon — 81-pt xwOBA edge vs RHP

Statcast PAs. xwOBA tint vs league .315 (red = better for the hitter). Grey: < 60 PA.

| SPLIT | PA | AVG | WOBA | XWOBA | K% | BB% | HR | BARREL | CHASE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **vs RHP** | 300 | .273 | .405 | .441 | 13.7% | 16.3% | 21 | 16.0% | 18% |
| **vs LHP** | 165 | .268 | .344 | .360 | 14.5% | 8.5% | 6 | 10.4% | 24% |

## COMPS Comps — closest offensive profile: Ben Rice

Nearest qualified hitters on barrel%, EV90, contact, chase, zone swing, pull-air, GB%, launch angle, whiff by pitch group, BB% and K% (standardized, weighted).

**Ben Rice NYY** Hit 50 Pwr 65 — 43% similar
LHB · 14.3% barrel · EV90 105.5 · 76% contact · 24% chase · xwOBA .378

**Seiya Suzuki CHC** Hit 50 Pwr 60 — 42% similar
RHB · 10.7% barrel · EV90 106.0 · 79% contact · 22% chase · xwOBA .340

**Curtis Mead BOS** Hit 60 Pwr 60 — 42% similar
RHB · 10.8% barrel · EV90 105.1 · 84% contact · 25% chase · xwOBA .358

**Grades.** z-score composites → percentile within hitters with ≥1,000 pitches seen → 50 + 10·Φ⁻¹(p), clipped 20–80, shown to the nearest 5. Hit = contact%, xBA, K%, whiff vs FB/BRK. Power = barrel%, EV90, max EV, ISO, hard-hit%. Discipline = chase%, zone-swing minus chase, BB%. Pull-air = pulled fly balls/liners share. Speed = FanGraphs Spd (sprint speed is not in this dataset). vs-pitch grades = hitter RV/100 by pitch group. **Models.** attack plan = situational pitch-type model scored against a league-average arsenal from each hand (this hitter's priors), then the location model's best zone for that pitch; alignment = shift-legal greedy optimizer over his balls in play with a catch-probability fielding model, gain reported 2-fold cross-validated (fit on half his BIP, scored on the other half). Predicted xwOBA gaps are small — the cited zone stats are his actual results. **Caveats.** single season, regular season only; zone cells with small samples greyed; xwOBA ignores park; alignment model is approximate (no runner/game state).